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Facing first-degree murder charge but free

Cape DA, victim's family question decision to allow bail for defendant

By Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

Right around closing time outside a Hyannis bar last March, Alex Greene allegedly held a gun to Tony Johnson's face and pulled the trigger. The single gunshot, fired so close that police say some of Johnson's blood ended up inside the barrel of the gun, killed him.

Cape Cod authorities quickly charged Greene with first-degree murder, and he was ordered held in jail, facing the possibility of life in

prison without parole. But last month, Greene was granted bail, \$100,000 in cash. He posted it immediately and was able to walk out of jail the next day, with the standard condition he wear a monitoring bracelet — a rare release for a defendant in a first-degree murder case.

But race and socioeconomic status add other dimensions to the bail decision: Greene is white, a firearms instructor at a popular local gun range who was set to begin

working as a Barnstable County sheriff's deputy that week, with the financial means to obtain a high-powered legal team and post high cash bail; Johnson was Black, an ex-con who floated among jobs and most recently worked at Home Depot, UPS, and Dollar General.

Now, Greene's release has raised alarms on the Cape, with some seeing an example of how the justice system can afford more leeway to white defendants who have the means to hire aggressive lawyers.

"If it would have been my child who shot a white person in the face, he would have had no bond," Johnson's mother, Mattie Johnson, 60,

told the Globe. And, she said, the unusual decision to grant bail in a first-degree murder case makes it feel like her son's life and death don't matter.

"My baby was a human being," Johnson said. "Don't let this go undone and don't let this go unnoticed."

The Cape and Islands district attorney's office is asking Superior Court Judge Beverly Cannone to reconsider her decision to grant Greene bail. A hearing is scheduled for Jan. 30.

The case is also distinguished by the unusual defense that Greene's

DEFENDANT, Page A5

Trump's year of seismic changes

Tariffs, deportations, power plays, and officials contend there's 'lots more to come'

By Jim Puzzanghera, Sam Brodey,
Julian E.J. Sorapuru, and Tal Kopan

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — President Trump spent the first year of his second term pushing — and in some cases obliterating — the limits of presidential authority. He goes into his second year hardly chastened, set to build on areas in which he's been successful and push back against the obstacles that judges and an often-reluctant Congress have erected.

The most visible front of his efforts has been on immigration enforcement, a continued focus from his first term.

His administration has sought sweeping terminations of visas while freezing new ones. Immigration and Customs Enforcement officers have descended upon American cities from Boston to Los Angeles in high-profile shows of force to round up undocumented immigrants. Those efforts have often been met with protests, most recently in Minneapolis, where a local motorist, Renee Good, was fatally shot by an ICE agent after a confrontation.

After Trump's attempts to deploy the National

ONE YEAR, Page A7

Visa crackdown packs a price, advocates say

Limits can hurt schools, businesses, groups assert

By Anjali Huynh, Omar Mohammed,
and Christopher Huffaker

GLOBE STAFF

Since Noorulhaq Sadeqi emigrated from Afghanistan to the United States with this brother-in-law in 2021, he's settled into a job with a New England nonprofit where he helps fellow immigrants get settled.

He said his brother-in-law has been granted asylum and has been trying to bring his wife to join him.

"His wife [was] left behind in Afghanistan. It's five years. He's affected by this travel ban. He's really, really depressed right now. He's not feeling OK," Sadeqi said on Thursday. "Like him, thousands of Afghan refugees are living around and all of them, they [are] stuck."

The federal government further limited legal immigration Wednesday when it announced it would suspend visa processing for immigrant applicants from 75 countries, who it claimed were more likely to seek public assistance, beginning this Wednesday.

The changes will especially make it difficult

VISAS, Page A6



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

A cyclist navigated cars double parked in the MBTA bus lane outside a Dunkin' at 1138 Washington St. in Boston.

The 411 on complaints to Boston's 311 system

Seaport parking issues said to top list while South End sees fastest responses

By Danny McDonald
and Neena Hagen

GLOBE STAFF

A 500-square-foot apartment rents for \$3,400 here. Leggings are \$100. Seafood curry is \$43. And parking in this high-end slice of the Seaport? Well, that's oftentimes worth a complaint to 311.

During 2025, a stretch of Congress Street was the most complained about address in Boston, and just about every call was about parking, according to a Boston Globe analysis of available city data.

The parking strategy of Isabella Bachman, a 28 year-old who was at a nearby dog park with her Australian shepherd, hinted at why.

She estimates that it would cost her at least \$400 a month for a parking spot. But, if she simply parks on specific streets in the neighborhood she knows to have relatively scant parking enforcement and eats the tickets she does get, she pays on average about \$120 a month.

"I take a gamble," she said.

Last year, 373 complaints were made to the city's 311 system for 391-397 Congress St., making it the most complained about address in Boston for that time frame. Ninety nine percent of the gripes were related to parking.

Paige Maling, a 26-year-old who works in medical sales who was also at the dog park

with her golden retriever that day, said she lives in a building that features \$600 a month parking. That doesn't necessarily guarantee her a spot, Maling said, as the parking garage is a mix of private and public parking. Sometimes there are no spots available. She's not surprised that part of the Seaport is home to the most complaints in the city, and the vast majority of them deal with where people put their cars.

"Very frustrating," she said of the parking situation in the Seaport.

For Khaled Eltokhy, an economist and PhD candidate at City University of New York whose research focuses on city governance,

PARKING, Page A6

In the news

Two Brandeis students created a friend-matching app meant to get Gen Z off their smart-phones. **D1.**

The collision of two high-speed trains in Spain left a tally of 40 dead. **A3.**

Top Catholic clerics criticized the US's new, aggressive approach to foreign policy. **A2.**

President Trump's verbal attacks and threats against immigrants from Somalia are taking a toll in neighborhoods in Maine's two largest cities: Portland and Lewiston. **B1.**

Segun Idowu, Boston's chief of economic opportunity and inclusion, is resigning. **B1.**

Indiana won its first football national title, beating Miami to cap a perfect season. **C1.**

'Most realistic'

To ER doctors and nurses, 'The Pitt' is more than a hit. It's their world, chaos and all.

By Jonathan Saltzman

GLOBE STAFF

Emergency room staff cut the clothes off an unresponsive homeless man, and several rats leap from his body onto the floor. Doctors examine a child who won't wake up and discover he ate one of his father's cannabis gummies. A patient who has waited hours to see a doctor angrily cold-cocks a nurse.

The plot threads in the hit HBO Max show "The Pitt," now in its second season, might seem like the product of an overactive imagination. But several doctors and nurses who work in emergency rooms in Massachusetts and Rhode Island said the series, which airs Thursdays, is so true to life that they urge family members to watch it to understand their jobs.

Others love the gritty show about the fictional Pittsburgh Trauma Medical Center but won't

THE PITT, Page A5

A DAY TO REFLECT A DAY TO ACT



JOSH REYNOLDS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Keynote speaker Nikole Hannah-Jones (left), Pulitzer Prize-winning creator of The 1619 Project, joined Representative Ayanna Pressley at the Martin Luther King Jr. Memorial Breakfast in Boston Monday. "In a nation that likes to brag that it's the oldest continuing democracy in the world, our democracy is not holding," Hannah-Jones said. **B1.**



Chill-suited

Tuesday: Lots of sun but cold. High 23-28, low 11-16.

Wednesday: Warmer, cloudy. High 30-35, low 26-31.

High tide: 12:01, 12:05.

Sunrise: 7:08. Sunset: 4:43.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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